

Qi Versus Power 2.0:

Who Will Win the Wireless Charging Challenge?



Like Wi-Fi vs HomeRF and Blu-Ray vs HD-DVD, we are now on the verge of another tech battle, as Qi and Power 2.0 vie to become the de-facto standard in the wireless charging space. While mobile manufacturers are backing one, coffee shops and food joints are backing another. Who will win—the conference room or the coffee shop? Or, will a newcomer jump the line?

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You place your phone on your bedside table, and it automatically starts charging. You place your hand-blender on the kitchen counter-top and it charges itself. You walk into a coffee shop or airport lobby, and your phones and tablets get a full power boost even as you recharge yourself with a coffee. That would really feel good, right? Well, such visions of 'wireless charging' are no longer a fantasy. Inductive charging or wireless charging

technology is gradually stabilising, and gaining popularity.

Silicon designers and manufacturers, including IDT, Texas Instruments, Freescale Semiconductor and Intel, are focusing on wireless charging chips (transceivers and receivers).

The latest mobile phones, such as the Nokia Lumia 920 and Samsung Galaxy S4, are capable of wireless charging. There are wireless charging sleeves for the iPhone and other devices, and there are dozens of wireless chargers (charging pads) available in the market from Duracell, Energizer, etc, including those

from JBL and Panasonic that double up as music players or alarm clocks. Food chains like Starbucks and McDonald's are piloting wireless charging services at their outlets, while building material manufacturers like DuPont are thinking on the lines of embedding wireless charging chips into kitchen countertops. Car manufacturers are incorporating in-car wireless charging for mobile phones, and technologies like Qualcomm Halo promise wireless charging of electric vehicles.

On top of that, there are also signs of emerging standards. The Wireless